THE R.I.S.E.™ ROADMAP

PRACTICAL PLANNING TOOLKIT

R - RESTORE

Emergency Savings Planner

Build money you can use when life surprises you.

BUILD YOUR OWN PLAN • 20 MINUTES

What you will walk away with

Work out how many months your accessible money could support you and set a realistic savings step.

BEFORE YOU START

A recent bank balance, household bills and an estimate of essential monthly spending. No need to include account numbers.

Your 5 steps

01 **See your situation**

02 Work out the numbers

03 Compare choices

04 Plan 30 days

05 Review your progress

See your situation

Having savings and having money ready for emergencies are not always the same thing.

STEP 1 OF 5 UNDERSTAND

Savings I can use quickly (RM)

Money not already needed for another bill

Money saved for a planned purchase (RM)

House deposit, school fees, etc.

My saving habit

Regular / Some months / Not yet

Main reason saving is difficult

Costs, debts, uneven income, other

Your monthly must-pay costs

Essential cost	Monthly amount (RM)	Could I reduce it?

REMEMBER

Do not count EPF retirement savings or money tied up in property as cash you can freely use tomorrow.

THREE QUESTIONS TO KEEP IN MIND

1. If your income stopped, what bills would still need paying?
2. Which savings can you use quickly without a big loss or penalty?
3. What makes saving difficult right now?

Work out the numbers

Choose a goal that fits your circumstances. PIDM uses six months as a common starting point and lets users explore different targets.

STEP 2 OF 5

DO THE MATHS

A SIMPLE EXAMPLE

EXAMPLE: Essential costs RM3,000/month; six-month goal RM18,000; available savings RM4,000. Still to build: RM14,000. Saving RM350/month takes about 40 months.

Now use your own numbers

Essential spending each month (RM)

Months of backup I want

Try 3, 6 or 9 as examples

My savings target (RM)

Monthly spending times months

Money I can use now (RM)

Still to save (RM)

Target minus money available

Monthly amount I can realistically save (RM)

WHAT YOUR NUMBER TELLS YOU

A target is not a judgment. Starting with RM20 or RM50 is still a step forward if that is what your budget allows.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU ACT

If you have overdue essentials, first make a plan to protect housing, food and other urgent commitments.

Compare your options

A good next step should fit your money, time and responsibilities - not only your hopes.

STEP 3 OF 5 EXPLORE

1 **Automatic transfer**

Move a small amount after payday into an accessible account.

2 **Find one expense to adjust**

Check subscriptions, eating out or repeated small spending without skipping essentials.

3 **Use irregular extra money**

Save part of a bonus or side-income payment when it arrives.

Compare your choices

Easy to keep doing?

Can I access it fast?

Any fees or penalties?

Before you decide, ask yourself

- [ ] Can I withdraw this money when I need it?
- [ ] Is this amount really available, or promised to another bill?
- [ ] What is the smallest monthly saving I can stick to?

Your 30-day action plan

Four small weekly steps are usually easier to keep than one big promise.

STEP 4 OF 5

TAKE ACTION

WEEK 1

List must-pay costs

Add housing, food, transport, utilities and loan minimums.

My step:

WEEK 2

Confirm accessible cash

Separate emergency money from savings for other goals.

My step:

WEEK 3

Start an automatic habit

Choose an achievable transfer on payday.

My step:

WEEK 4

Check one month

Review what worked; adjust the next transfer if needed.

My step:

Make it real

My first action in the next 48 hours:

Date I will check my progress:

Review & take the next step

Come back after 30 days. A useful plan changes when life or the numbers change.

STEP 5 OF 5

KEEP IMPROVING

What I track	Today	In 30 days
Accessible emergency money (RM)		
Essential spending (RM)		
Months of backup		
Monthly saving amount (RM)		

Your reflections

What unexpected expense could happen next month?

What gets in the way of saving?

What small change will I keep?

WHEN IT IS WORTH GETTING HELP

If you are unsure what money is truly accessible or your debts block saving, a budget review can help you choose a safe first step.

Good questions to bring to a review

- What is a suitable emergency goal for my household?
- How do I balance building savings and paying down debt?

Want someone to help you see the bigger picture?

Chat with Balla DK on WhatsApp • No obligation

WHATSAPP →

RESEARCH & FURTHER READING

PIDM - Emergency savings calculator

AKPK - MyBijak Kewangan

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